

After a Traffic Crash

Safety and information checklist

CHECKLIST

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Stay safe first. Exchange factual information, document what you can safely, and contact your insurer as soon as practical. Reporting requirements vary by location.

Immediately after a crash

- 1 Stop safely** and turn on hazard lights.
- 2 Check for injuries:** yourself, passengers, and others.
- 3 Call 911** for injuries, danger, blocked traffic, suspected impairment, fire, unsafe conditions, or when police assistance is needed.
- 4 Move vehicles only when safe and lawful;** otherwise stay buckled or move to a safe spot away from traffic.
- 5 Do not argue** about fault or assign blame.
- 6 Exchange information** with the other driver(s).
- 7 Take photos and notes** when it is safe to do so.
- 8 Contact your insurer** promptly.

! Do not leave the scene unless directed by law enforcement, or to obtain emergency aid or protect safety.

Driver information received *One set per other driver involved*

Other driver

NAME

ADDRESS

PHONE

DRIVER LICENSE NO. / STATE

Vehicle

YEAR / MAKE / MODEL / COLOR

LICENSE PLATE / STATE

OWNER (IF DIFFERENT)

DAMAGE NOTED

Insurance

INSURANCE COMPANY

POLICY NUMBER

INSURER PHONE

CLAIM NUMBER

Crash details

DATE / TIME

LOCATION (STREET, MILE MARKER, DIRECTION)

WITNESS NAME / PHONE

OFFICER / AGENCY

REPORT NUMBER

TOW COMPANY / PHONE

WHERE VEHICLE WAS TOWED

Photos to take (when safe)

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| ☐ All vehicles, all sides | ☐ License plates | ☐ Road and weather conditions |
| ☐ Damage close-up | ☐ Scene, signs, and signals | ☐ Insurance cards (with permission) |

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Glove-box card. Fill this out ahead of time so you can hand accurate information to the other driver without reading it aloud or handing over your license.

CUT ALONG DASHED LINE

MY INFORMATION — GIVE TO THE OTHER DRIVER

Keep in your glove box with your registration and proof of insurance

NAME

ADDRESS

PHONE

DRIVER LICENSE NO. / STATE

VEHICLE YEAR / MAKE / MODEL / COLOR

LICENSE PLATE / STATE

INSURANCE COMPANY

POLICY NUMBER

INSURANCE PHONE NUMBER



Reminder: Exchange factual information. Take photos when safe. Do not argue or admit fault.

Make it last

- 1 Fill in with permanent ink, then cut along the dashed line.
- 2 Laminate (optional): a self-seal laminating pouch or clear packing tape on both sides works.
- 3 Keep with your registration and proof of insurance; update after a new vehicle or policy.



After the scene

- **Notify your insurer** and write down the claim number.
- **Keep together:** photos, notes, towing and repair documents, report information, and the claim number.
- **Do not sign documents you do not understand.** Ask questions or get help first.

Claim and follow-up log

Date	Who I spoke with (insurer, shop, agency)	Claim / reference no.	Notes / next step